

CHIRUNDU TOWN COUNCIL



**ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION, HEALTH
&MANAGEMENT POLICY**

2023-2026

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION POLICY

1.0 Introduction

Chirundu Town Council is committed to ensure the mainstreaming of environmental concerns in development plans and programmes in order to enhance sustainability. The environment plays a vital role in the healthy living of human beings. It provides air, food and other needs and also regulates air and climate. The local authority is aware of many environmental problems affecting people globally such as land degradation, deforestation, waste disposal, loss of biodiversity, ozone depletion, global warming and climate change. In the same vein, the district is grappling with poor rainfall resulting in long dry spells, excessive heat, land degradation and deforestation among others. This policy seeks to highlight how Chirundu Town Council will promote environmental issues to enhance the well-being of residents in Chirundu District.

Chirundu Town Council is also mandated in ensuring the mainstreaming of HIV/AIDS activities at district level. The Council provides the basis rules that are put in place for a comprehensive workplace program, which consists of prevention, care and protection of human rights depending on the particular situation, it also has a detailed HIV/AIDS workplace policy which is in draft, setting out programs such as agreement on safety, health and working conditions.

2.0 Organization's vision

A district with a diversified economy and improved livelihoods by 2030".

3.0 Organization's mission

"Chirundu district is committed to facilitate poverty reduction programmes through effective use of local and external resources based on community participation in an integrated approach while emphasizing honesty, transparency, integrity, accountability and equity".

4.0 Organisation's values

Accountability: We acknowledge responsibility for every action we take in fulfilling our mandate.

Transparency: It is our obligation to show openness and fairness when discharging our responsibilities without fear or favor.

Professionalism: We conduct ourselves in an excellent and competent manner.

Integrity: we are honesty, upright and reliable in all actions according to our values and principles.

Teamwork: We work together cohesively, supporting each other to enhance team performance.

These values will help in nurturing our organizational culture that will influence the behavior of the Council and administrative staff as they relate to clients and stakeholders.

5.0 Policy statement

Chirundu Town Council acknowledges a responsibility to take care of the environment and we express our commitment towards implementing practices which will promote sustainable development.

Management and employees are required to govern the management of the environmental aspects of the organization, with specific focus on conservation of resources, planting of trees at the office and their homes, making the environment clean and green and the reduction of waste by following proper waste disposal methods.

All management and employees have a role to play in contributing towards reviewing and improving the policy so as to integrate environmental and social consideration in their everyday practices. By doing so, the local authority and the residents of Chirundu will be adequately prepared for the climate change effects and will not experience unexpected environmental hazards but will put in place adequate mitigation measures to reduce the impacts of environmental hazards.

6.0 Reference to Acts

This policy refers to all the under listed relevant national legislation, laws and conventions to which Zambia is party

Environmental Management Act number 12 of 2011

S.I. No. 112 of 2013

Convention on biological Diversity

Paris Agreement on Climate Change

National Climate Change Policy

Forests Act No. 4 of 2015

Water Resources Management Act No. 21 of 2011

8th National Development Plan

-National HIV/AIDS/STI/TB Policy

7.0 Policy objectives

The objectives of this policy are:

To ensure higher resource flows, management skills, traditional knowledge, and social capital, for environmental conservation through mutually beneficial multi stakeholder partnerships

To integrate environmental concerns into policies, plans, programmes, and projects for economic and social development

To evaluate different forms of council procedures and processes in order to enhance sustainable development

To ensure compliance with statutory and legal set standards

To improve disaster preparedness, management and response

-To ensure that the target of 95% of people living with HIV be aware of their status, 95% of those aware their status to be on antiretroviral therapy (ART) and 95% of those on ART achieve viral load suppression (UNAIDS 95 95 95) by 2030

8.0 Policy guiding principles

The guiding principles of this policy are:

1. Comply with any laws governing the environment and actively look for ways to improve these guidelines
2. Work towards the conservation of energy, water and resources in all our operations
3. Promote environmental awareness throughout all our operations.
4. Management shall take disciplinary action against employees who do not comply with this policy.
5. Strive to understand the direct and indirect impacts that our practices may have on the environment.
6. Lessen our environmental impacts by purchasing environmentally friendly products and services.
7. Dispose waste thoughtfully and develop an attitude of “reducing, recycling and reusing
8. Protect the rights of those affected by HIV/AIDS as well as educate the preventive measures through trainings and sensitization.

8.1 Representation of Civic Leaders

Chirundu Town Council will ensure that people dealing with environmental issues are equitably represented at Council or committee level. The Health and Environment Committee (HEC) of the Council is the committees that will spear-head the environmental policy implementation in the local authority from ward development committee level to the sub-committees to the entire Council. The HEC will also have a role to play in the review and improvement of the policy so as to integrate environmental considerations in their everyday practices as well as solicit community participation in environmental management and conservation.

In addition, all HIV/AIDS activities at district level are reported to the Health and Environment Committee (HEC). The HIV/AIDS workplace policy is in draft and it outlines the response and impact mitigation interventions that are already in place, while also stating the vision, measures, institutional and legal frameworks necessary for its implementation.

8.2 Recruitment of Staff

Chirundu Town Council will recruit personnel based on their level of competence. It will further and as much as possible hire individuals who are knowledgeable and competent in environmental concerns, both in the office and in the programs/projects they develop.

The Organization will also endeavor to create an environment in which all new employees will be made welcome and capable of making positive contributions.

Chirundu Town Council also treats employees who are infected or affected by HIV/AIDS with empathy and care, the council provides all the reasonable assistance which includes counseling, time off, sick leave, family responsibility leave and information regarding the virus and its effect.

8.3 Reuse, Reduce, Recycle

Chirundu Town Council will;

- Reduce our waste stream by increasing our recycling and compositing capabilities by at least 60%

- Reduce our waste generation by procuring things in bulk

- Reuse materials by mending or repairing other than replacing

- Compost all food and landscape waste

- Promote the use of natural energy and solar lighting

- Use envelopes and other packaging as well as purchase reusable products.

- Conserve water by using appliances that discourage waste

Enter into public-private partnerships (PPPs) with companies that are ready to buy materials from the locals to be used for recycling.

Reduce consumption of energy and materials

Encourage mindset change by being mindful of consumption, our relationship with things and our relationship with the earth

-Educate on the correct use of the condom as well disposing in the correct place after use.

8.4 Conserve

Chirundu Town Council will conserve the environment by;

Saving water and water bodies from pollution

Discouraging excess cutting down of trees

Integrated land resource management

Saving forest reserves

Recycling, reusing and reducing toxins and material that harm the environment

Discourage open air burning and indiscriminate waste disposal.

-Discourage disposing of used condoms anyhow.

8.5 Training and Education

Chirundu Town Council will ensure that employees are trained when necessary and all are aware of environmental protections and the policies and regulations in place.

It will educate all employees on resource conservation and pollution prevention through;

- Training programmes on recycling, reusing and reducing waste
- Offer incentives to encourage environmental preferable practices
- Inform employees on environmental issues in other trainings and staff meetings
- Conduct drama shows within the communities on environmental protection
- Ensuring career progression for those dealing with environmental matters
- Encourage environmental stewardship

8.6 Occupational safety and Health

Chirundu Town Council will periodically assess Occupational, Safety and Health standards within the workplace and as much as possible and where necessary implement specific action to reduce any OSH hazards identified this will include looking at causes of stress strains and diseases in the workplace. Particular attention will be given to ensure all employees exposed to different hazards during the course of their job execution are provided with the necessary personal protective equipment

8.7 Communication to the outside world

With its strong commitment, Chirundu Town Council will endeavor to publish research and articles on its environmental protection awareness approach in newsletter academic journals and books and to make presentations at professional meets to highlight its commitment publicly send to share its best practices in reaching out to everyone on environmental matters.

The Council will ensure that all internal communication reflect awareness, use appropriate language and include information on its programmes/projects and activities involving environmental awareness.

9.0 Programmes

Chirundu Town Council will:

- Manage effectively Environmental Planning implications in order to enhance implementation of District development plans and programmes .

- Carry out environmental education in order to solicit for community participation in environmental management and conservation.

- Evaluate and compare different forms of Council policies, procedures, processes of implementation and practice in order to enhance sustainable development.

Apply environmental protection mainstreaming at all stages of policy and programmes work, including planning implementation, impact assessment and development of measurable indicators

Use participatory methodologies in its programs planning which will include and take into account the all-environmental matters.

Our programmes design will integrate environmental protection in its goals, objectives, strategies and implementation plans.

-Collect, distribute, educate and sensitize on the correct usage of a condom.

10.0 The institution management of the environmental protection policy

The Planning department is the department in charge to ensure implementation of the policy. The District Planning Officer is accountable for the implementation of the policy and will report on the implementation process bi-annually to the Council. The focal point person is the Environmental Planner and Senior Health Inspector.

To promote environmental protection mainstreaming within the Council, it may also be necessary to appoint more staff members with specific responsibilities for overseeing the environmental mainstreaming processes.

11.0 Code of conduct for the staff and complaint procedures

Where a member of staff, a councilor or a stakeholder believes that there has been a failure or breach of the policy, he or she should follow the complaint procedures identified in the Chirundu Town Council workplace policy.

12.0 Resource for the Implementation of environmental protection policy strategies

Chirundu Town Council management will ensure adequate resources (including staff capacity funds etc.) are adequately budgeted for in the annual budget and supplementary budget, if need be, and also ensure funds are made available to accomplish the Council's external and internal environmental protection awareness goals.

13.0 Conclusion: Monitoring evaluation and review of policy

Chirundu Town Council has adopted a policy of zero tolerance towards environmental degradation viz a viz open air burning, indiscriminate waste disposal, land degradation and poor waste management. To support values of environmental protection and sustainability, the Council will apply those values in its own employment decisions. Chirundu Town Council will review this policy on an annual basis through management meetings and eventually the Health and Environment Committee and revise it as necessary to ensure that it is accomplishing its goals.